भारत सरकार, गृह मंत्रालय
Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India
भारत के महारजिस्ट्रार का कार्यालय
OFFICE OF THE REGISTRAR GENERAL, INDIA
जनगणना भवन, टावर-ए, 2-ए, मान सिंह रोड, नई दिल्ली-110011
Janganana Bhawan, Tower-A, 2/A, Man Singh Road,
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जनगणना प्रभाग/**Census Division**

No. 9/29/2025-CD(CEN) Dated: 26.11.2025

CENSUS OF INDIA 2027 - Circular No. 5

Subject: Appointment of Census Functionaries.

The Indian Census is the largest administrative exercise in the world, conducted under the legal provisions of Census Act, 1948 and Census Rules, 1990, as amended from time to time. The intention of the Government of India to conduct the Census of India 2027 has been notified in the official gazette on 16th June 2025 and republished in the State/ Union Territory (UT) Gazettes. The Census of India 2027 would be conducted in two phases: (i) Houselisting and Housing Census - April to September 2026 and (ii) Population Enumeration: February, 2027 (For the UT of Ladakh and snow bound non-synchronous areas of UT of Jammu & Kashmir and states of Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand, PE shall be conducted in September, 2026). The Census 2027 will make extensive use of technology to enhance the quality of data collection and enable faster data release.

2. Census 2027 will be in digital mode, a transformational step towards modernising the Census process. Enumerators and Supervisors will use their own mobile for data collection and submit data digitally to Central Server. The Census mobile apps , portal and other digital tools will be available for both Android as well as iOS version. These apps will be in Hindi, English as well as in 14 Regional languages. Census 2027 will also have the option to self-enumerate for the public.

3. About 30 lakh field functionaries will be deployed to complete this task of national importance covering entire country within a fixed time frame. A web portal i.e. Census Management and Monitoring System (CMMS) for Census 2027 has been developed to manage and monitor all activities like appointment of Enumerators/ Supervisors, assigning the Enumeration Blocks/ Supervisory Circles to them and real time progress of the field work. With all these new initiatives for Census 2027, **it becomes all the more important to initiate the appointment of Census officers well in advance and complete all other formalities like registration of Census functionaries on CMMS portal with correct and complete details.**

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4. As per the Rule 4 of the Census Rules, 1990 of Census Act, 1948, the Directors of Census Operations (DCO) appointed under sub-section 1 of Section 4 of the Census Act are hereby designated as Chief Principal Census Officers to supervise the taking of the Census within their respective States and Union Territories. In addition, the Deputy Registrar General (C&T), the Joint Director of Census Operations, the Deputy Director of Census Operations and the Assistant Director of Census Operations are also being designated by this office as the Addl. Chief Principal Census Officer, Joint Chief Principal Census Officer, Deputy Chief Principal Census Officer and Assistant Chief Principal Census Officer respectively within the jurisdiction of the concerned State or Union Territory (UT).

5. **Under Section 4(2) of the Census Act, 1948, the officers responsible for taking the Census are to be appointed by the respective State Government and UT Administrations for their respective jurisdictions.** The levels and details of Officers who will be appointed as Census Officers by State Government/Union Territory Administration, as per Rule 3 of the Census Rules, 1990, for the areas under their jurisdictions are at ***Annexure I and II.***

6. In the districts, the District Collectors/District Magistrates or any nominated Officer are designated as Principal Census Officers under sub-section (2) of Section 4 of the Act and are responsible for the Census Operations in their jurisdiction. In the Division, wherever it exists, the Divisional Commissioner will act as a Divisional Census Officer.

7. In the Municipal Corporations, the Municipal Commissioner/ the Administrative Head of Municipal Corporation would function as the Principal Census Officer or Addl. Principal Census Officer or Charge Officer, as the case may be.

8. As has been the practice in earlier Censuses, other officers of the appropriate levels such as Additional District Collectors/ Additional District Magistrates or Senior Deputy Collector may be appointed as District Census Officers under sub-section (2) of Section 4 of the Census Act. In the Municipal Corporations, Deputy Municipal Commissioners/ the Deputy Administrative Head of Municipal Corporations, as the case may be, may be designated as the City Census Officers for the relevant areas. Apart from these, it would be essential to appoint officers in-charge of specific areas which constitute part of their normal administrative jurisdiction such as District Planning Officer/District Statistical Officer/District Informatics Officer/ District Education Officer as Additional District Census Officer and Sub-divisional or Revenue Divisional Officers as Sub-Divisional Census Officer. The various levels and designations which need to be appointed for Rural and Urban areas are given in the ***Annexure-I and Annexure-II.*** **These levels are not exhaustive and may require suitable modifications as per local requirements of the respective State/Union Territory.** It is suggested that the appointments of the

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State/UT Govt. may preferably be by designation of the Officers instead of names, otherwise for any change /replacement of the Officer due to administrative reasons, fresh appointment orders would be required.

9. There are certain populated areas that fall within the sole occupation and control of Defence Services, Central Reserve Police, Border Security Force and similar military or para-military organizations. For such exclusive areas, the Director of Census Operations has to determine the Special Charge Officers in consultation with the concerned authorities. Further, in consultation with the concerned designated Special Charge Officers, Census Officers at other levels also are to be appointed for such specific areas. The Chief Principal Census Officer (Director of Census Operations) is to obtain the updated list of Special Charges from the Principal Census Officers and may, through her/his order, designate Special Charge Officers as well as other Census Officers at various levels and they may not necessarily be gazetted officers. It must be emphasized here that areas under Cantonment Board will be treated at par with Statutory Towns and notified area committees etc. Special areas referred to in the beginning of this para are distinct from Cantonment Board areas as such. The Principal Census Officer (both the District Magistrate/District Collector and the Municipal Commissioners) would be responsible for identifying such Special Charges in their jurisdiction and provide a list of all such Special Charges to the concerned DCO. They would also make all necessary arrangements for conducting the Census (Phase-II - Population Enumeration) in all such Special Charges falling within their jurisdiction as per the guidelines of Office of Registrar General & Census Commissioner of India/ Director of Census Operations.

10. Sometimes, there may be special colonies under the control of Government or public sector authorities such as railways, irrigation, forest, thermal power stations etc. It is obligatory on the Principal Census Officer to identify all such special colonies in his/her jurisdiction and ensure to appoint Special Charge Census Officers in these areas for both the phases of Census Operation i.e., Houselisting & Housing Census and Population Enumeration. The Principal Census Officers are to provide the consolidated list of all such special colonies to the respective DCO to ensure a complete coverage of the population.

11. The Enumerators and Supervisors are the primary Census functionaries responsible for collection of data during Census taking. An Enumerator is to be assigned the work of about 700-800 population and one Supervisor is to be engaged for every six Enumerators. Besides, there shall be ten percent reserve Enumerators / Supervisors for any contingencies. As per Rule 3 of the Census Rules 1990, teachers, clerks or any official of the State Government, local authority etc. can be appointed as Enumerator while Supervisor will be officer generally of a rank higher than Enumerator. Though the appointment of Enumerators and Supervisors, who will be

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undertaking actual data collection, will be done at a later stage, it is essential that in view of the new initiatives for Census 2027, as detailed in above paras, they may be identified in advance and their details as per ***Annexure-III*** may be collected for registering them in CMMS portal by the respective Charge Officers.

12. The State Government and Union Territory Administration are requested that all the Census Officers with different designations appointed under Sub-Section (2) of Section 4 be delegated the powers of appointing Census Officers under Sub-Section (4) of Section 4 of the Census Act. Similarly, the State Government/ Union Territory Administration may also authorize them to sign declaration under provision of Sub-Section (3) of Section 4.

13. **The State Government/ Union Territory Administration are requested to ensure the appointment of Census functionaries as detailed in the Circular latest by 15th January 2026**. The concerned DCO would liaise with the Nodal Departments in the respective States/UTs for appointment of Census Officers as per the need and previous practices. Copies of all the appointment orders issued by the State Government/ UT Administration for all levels are to be sent to this office for information and record purposes.

Enclosures: As stated above

Narayanm 26.11.2025

(Mritunjay Kumar Narayan)
Registrar General & Census Commissioner of India
Telephone: 011-23388132
Email: rgi.rgi@gov.in

To

The Chief Secretaries all States/UTs.

Copy for necessary action to:

1. State Coordinators
2. Directorate of Census Operations
3. All heads of Divisions of ORGI including Language Division, Kolkata
4. Census Division, ORGI
5. PPS to RG&CC I
6. PPS to Addl. Registrar Generals (S)/DDG(BD), ORGI
7. PS to Sr. Technical Director (IT), Shastri Park for uploading on official website

Annexure-I

Division, District, Sub-Division and Tehsil Level Appointments

Sl. No.	Level	Authorities	Designation	Remarks
1	2	*3*	*4*	*5*
1	Division	Divisional Commissioner	Divisional Census Officer	An appointment order requires to be issued for her/his jurisdiction.
2	District	District Collector/ District Magistrate/ Deputy Commissioner or Administrative Heads of District or any nominated officer	Principal Census Officer	An appointment order requires to be issued for her/his jurisdiction.
3	District	Additional District Collector/Additional District Magistrate/Senior Deputy Collector, etc.	District Census Officer	An appointment order requires to be issued for her/his jurisdiction.
4	District	District Planning Officer/District Statistical Officer/District Informatics Officer/ District Education Officer/ Any other district level officer	Additional/Deputy District Census Officer	An appointment order requires to be issued for her/his jurisdiction.
5	Sub-divisions	Sub-Divisional Officers/Sub-Collector/ Sub-Divisional Magistrate	Sub-Divisional Census Officer	An appointment order requires to be issued for her/his jurisdiction.
6	Tahsil/Taluk/ Development Block/Mandal/ Panchayat Samiti	Tahsildar/Mamalatdar/BDO/Mandal Officer/Circle Officer	Charge Census Officer	An appointment order requires to be issued for her/his jurisdiction.
7	Tahsil/Taluk/ Development Block/Mandal/ Panchayat Samiti	Additional Tahsildars/Naib Tahsildars or equivalent	Additional Charge Census Officer	An appointment order requires to be issued for her/his jurisdiction.

Annexure-II

CITY, TOWN AND WARD LEVEL APPOINTMENTS

Sl. No.	Level	Authorities	Designation	Remarks
1	2	3	4	5
1	Municipal Corporation	Municipal Commissioner/ Administrative Head of Municipal Corporation or equivalent	Principal Census Officer /Addl. Principal Census Officer/Charge Census Officer	An appointment order requires to be issued designating the officer concerned as mentioned in col. 4 for her/his jurisdiction.
2	Municipal Corporation/ City	Additional Municipal Commissioner/ Deputy Municipal Commissioner/ Deputy Administrative Head of Municipal Corporation as the case may be	City Census Officer	An appointment order requires to be issued for her/his jurisdiction.
3	Municipal towns/ Notified areas/Cantonment board/Sanitary board and similar statutory areas under separate local authorities	Chief Officer/ Executive Officer/Secretary/ Administrator	Charge Census Officer	An appointment order requires to be issued for her/his jurisdiction.
4	Divisions or zone or group of wards or single ward in the Municipal Corporation	Appropriate levels below Municipal Commissioner/Administrative Head of M. Corp	Charge Census Officer	An appointment order requires to be issued for her/his jurisdiction.
5	Divisions or zone or group of wards or single ward in the Municipal Corporation	Appropriate levels below Charge Officer	Additional Charge Census Officer	An appointment order requires to be issued for her/his jurisdiction.

Details of Census Officers, Enumerators and Supervisors

Sl. No.	Item of information	Details
1	Name	
2	Role as Census Officer	
3	Sex	
4	Age	
5	Designation	
6	Office Name and Address	
7	Mobile Number	
8	Email Address	
9	Identity Document Type	
10	Identity Document Number	